PREFACE AND ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

No Asian conflict has proved more deadly, costly, or intractable than that which continues to divide India and Pakistan over Kashmir. For the past half-century, since I first became aware of this conflict's potential for regional destruction, I have pondered the alternatives for its resolution. Many wise friends—Indian, Pakistani, American, European, and Australian—have assisted me in understanding the complexity of the conflict.

When I chaired the History Department at UCLA, Rafique A. Khan, a leader of the Kashmiri community in Los Angeles, first urged me to organize an academic conference to explore how to help achieve peace in Kashmir. Prior commitments and obstacles, however, prevented me from launching so ambitious a project until April 2002, when the Ronald W. Burkle Center for International Relations at UCLA agreed to be its sponsor.

That center's director, Professor Michael Intriligator, cochaired our conference, "Ways to Help Resolve One of the World's Most Dangerous Conflicts." We invited scholars and other speakers from India, Pakistan, Washington, D.C., and London to participate in the Sunday conference, which we hoped to conclude by approving a set of appropriate resolutions to be sent to the United Nations and to Washington, New Delhi, and London.

Our conference brought together some four hundred Kashmiri Muslims, Hindu Pandits, and other Indo-Pakistani scholars and community leaders, filling our faculty center's largest room and terrace, the first so diverse a group assembled to focus on the Kashmir conflict on any campus in America. Many probing questions were asked during our morning sessions, stimulating fruitful discussions of alternative paths